

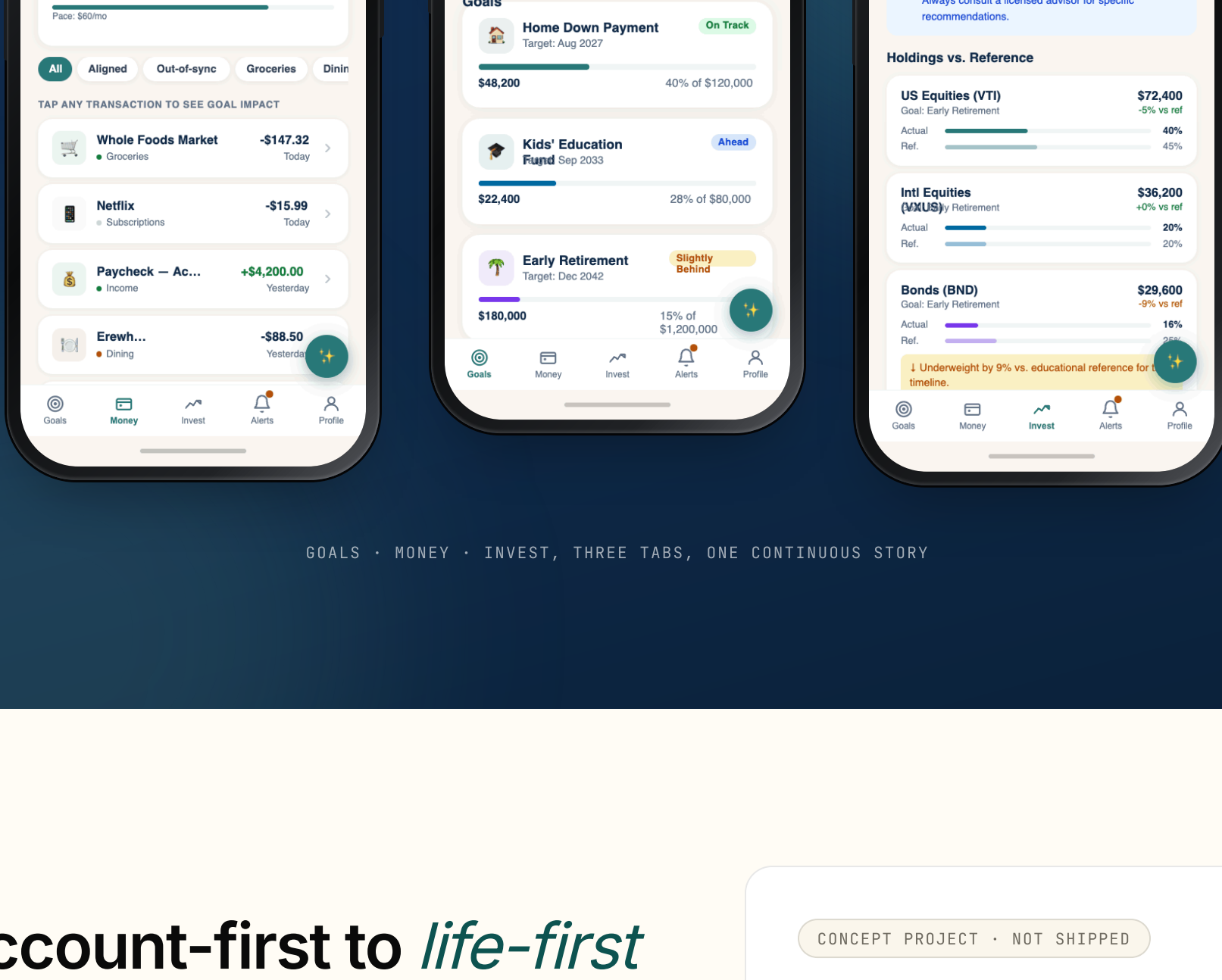
RECENT CASE STUDY • FINTECH

Goals-Driven Finance

Reframing money around the life you're building, not the accounts you happen to hold. Transparent AI turns everyday spending into goal impact, with compassion in place of shame.

Open in new tab

Jump to live build



GOALS • MONEY • INVEST, THREE TABS, ONE CONTINUOUS STORY

THE IDEA

From account-first to *life-first finance*

Most adults have capable financial tools, yet financial anxiety is at record highs. Finance is presented as accounts and balances, but people think in goals, the people they love, and the milestones they fear missing.

I led this concept end-to-end: synthesizing research into a comprehensive PRD, defining the IA and visual system, then building a working, navigable iOS prototype with an AI-assisted toolchain.

CONCEPT PROJECT • NOT SHIPPED

CAPABILITIES

Market & User Research

Product Design

PRD & Documentation

AI Spec & Prototype

Platform

iOS (mobile)

Toolchain

Claude • Cursor

GitHub

ROLE

Lead Product Designer

DURATION

Self-directed, 2026

INDUSTRY

FinTech

Personal Finance

DATA

Synthetic personas

CHALLENGE

Understanding the *money-life gap*

Before a single screen, I mapped why a decade of personal-finance tools left the same need unmet. Five gaps surfaced repeatedly, and each became a design constraint rather than a feature request.

GAP 01

No single story

People hold 3–7 accounts; every app shows a slice. The user is left as the integrator.

GAP 02

Backward-looking

Tools report what you spent. The question people ask is forward: what does this mean for what I want?

GAP 03

Shame as default

Deficit framing drives avoidance. People want to be treated as adults making trade-offs.

GAP 04

Investing fear

Most users don't want to pick stocks. They want to know if what they hold matches what they're trying to achieve.

GAP 05

Opaque automation

AI nudges are everywhere; their reasoning rarely is. People accept guidance only when they understand its basis.

THE OPENING

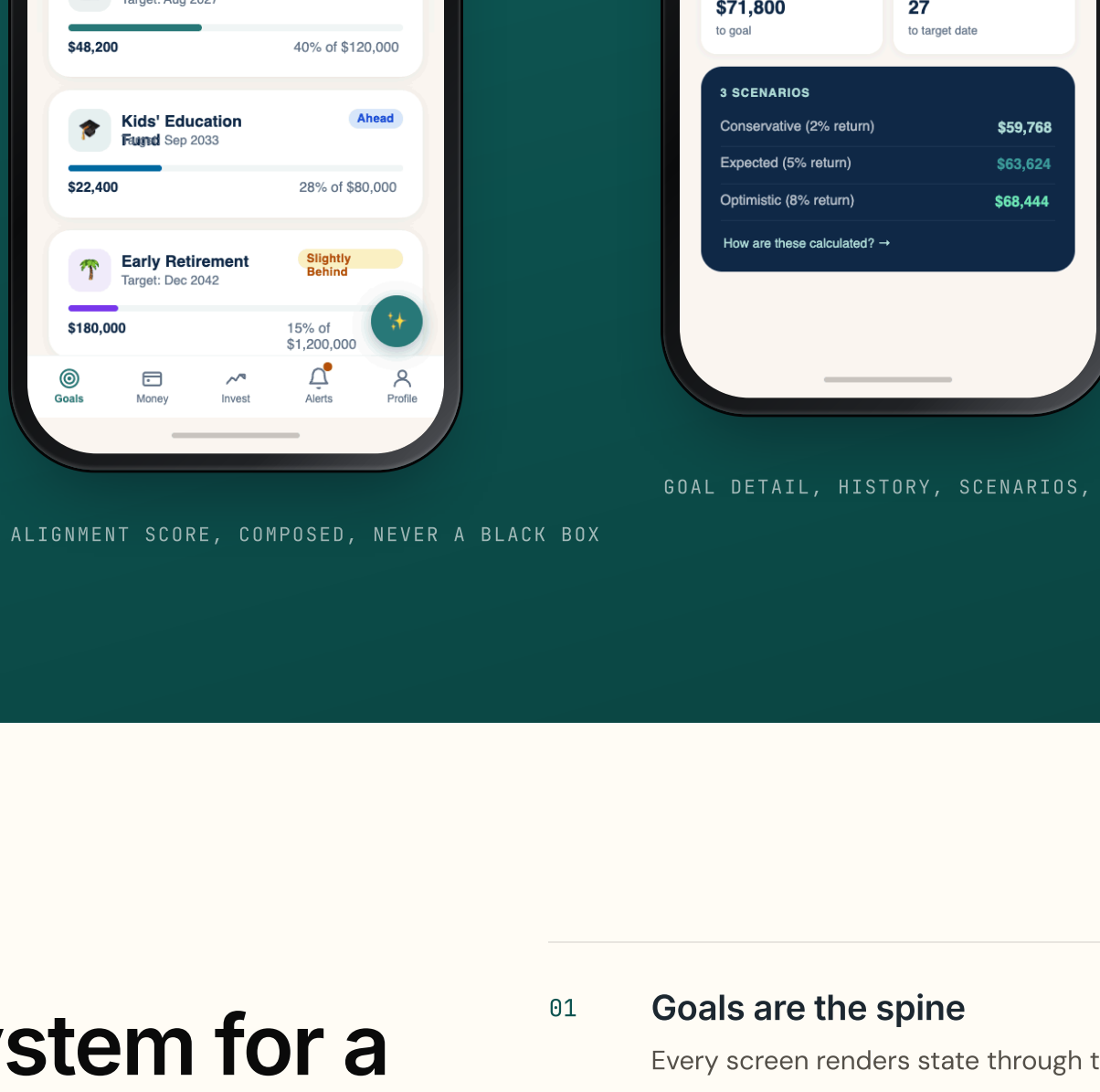
Timing

Open Banking (CFPB §1033), cheap explainable AI, and Mint's sunset created a rare moment of willingness to switch.

GOALS & ALIGNMENT

One number for *"am I on track?"*

The headline isn't a balance, it's the Goal Alignment Score: a single interpretable read on whether today's behaviour serves tomorrow's goals. Tap it and every weighted component is revealed.



ALIGNMENT SCORE, COMPOSED, NEVER A BLACK BOX

GOAL DETAIL, HISTORY, SCENARIOS, INLINE EDIT

APPROACH

A calm system for a *tense subject*

Money is emotional. The system is deliberately quiet: a warm, paper-like canvas for everyday surfaces, deep navy reserved for moments that carry weight, and a single trustworthy teal for action. Six principles break ties when decisions conflict.

5

Persistent tabs, no hidden menus

1

Most-recommended action per surface

01

Goals are the spine

Every screen renders state through the user's goals, spending, investing, and net worth are all read as goal impact.

02

Show the math

Every projection and nudge surfaces a plain-language "Why?", the arithmetic is always one tap away.

03

Compassion over shame

No deficit framing, no streaks that punish breakage. Drift always comes with a concrete path back.

04

Information, not advice

The assistant explains, projects, and educates, it never issues personalized buy/sell recommendations.

05

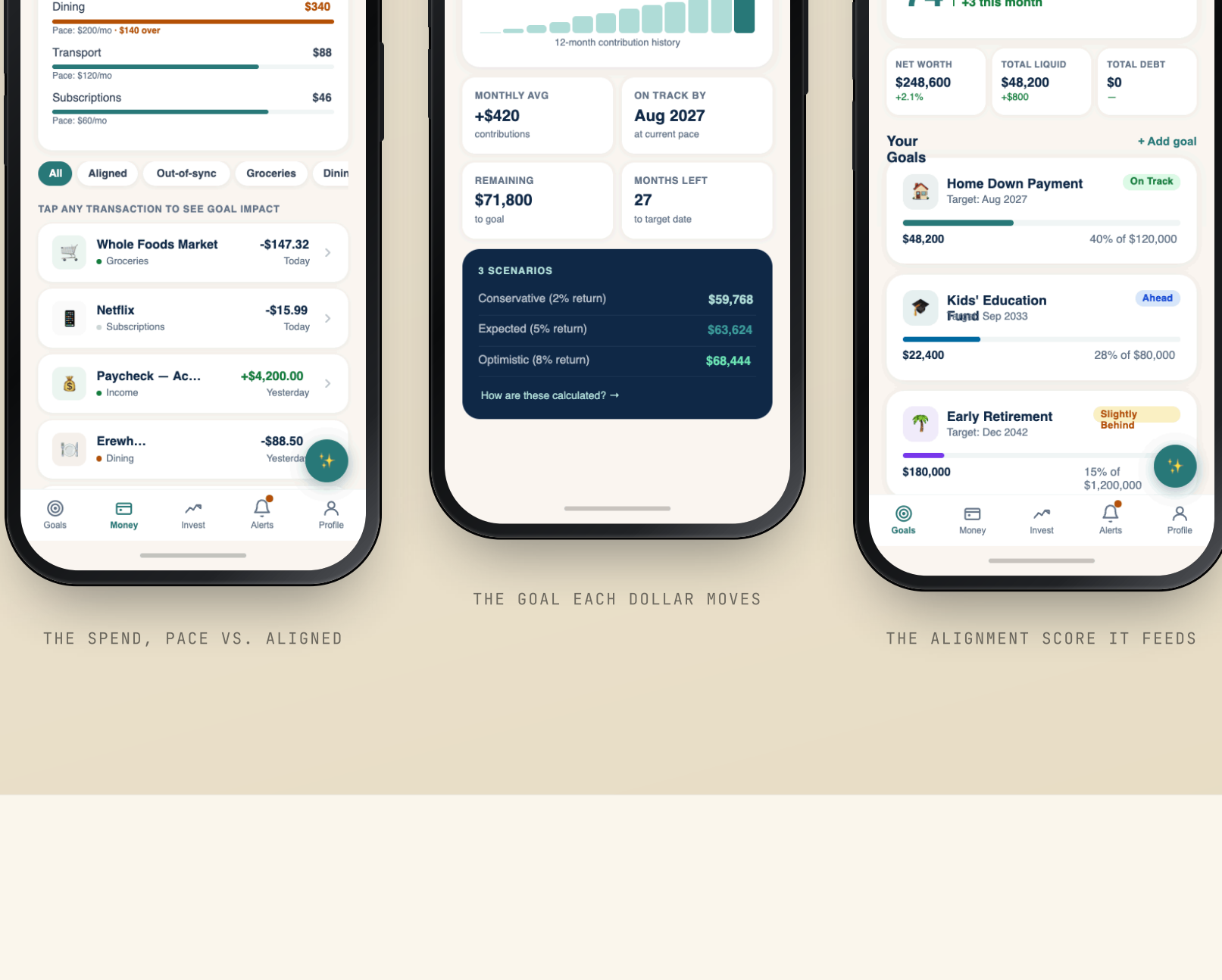
Privacy is a product

Users see what data we hold, why, and can revoke it easily, read-only access, CFPB §1033 compliant.

SPENDING INTELLIGENCE

Every transaction, *rendered through your goals*

Spending and investing as one continuous narrative. An \$88 dinner becomes "42 days later on your home goal", with the math one tap away and a path to recover it.



THE SPEND, PACE VS. ALIGNMENT

THE GOAL EACH DOLLAR MOVES

THE ALIGNMENT SCORE IT FEEDS

OUTCOME

Earning trust, *screen by screen*

Onboarding teaches the product's worldview and earns permission to connect a financial life, opening with values before ever asking to link an account, and closing on a populated dashboard with an animated net-worth reveal.

VALUES BEFORE ASKS

The first screens set the philosophy, connection, transparency, compassion, so linking an account feels earned, not extracted.

GUIDANCE CAN INTERROGATE

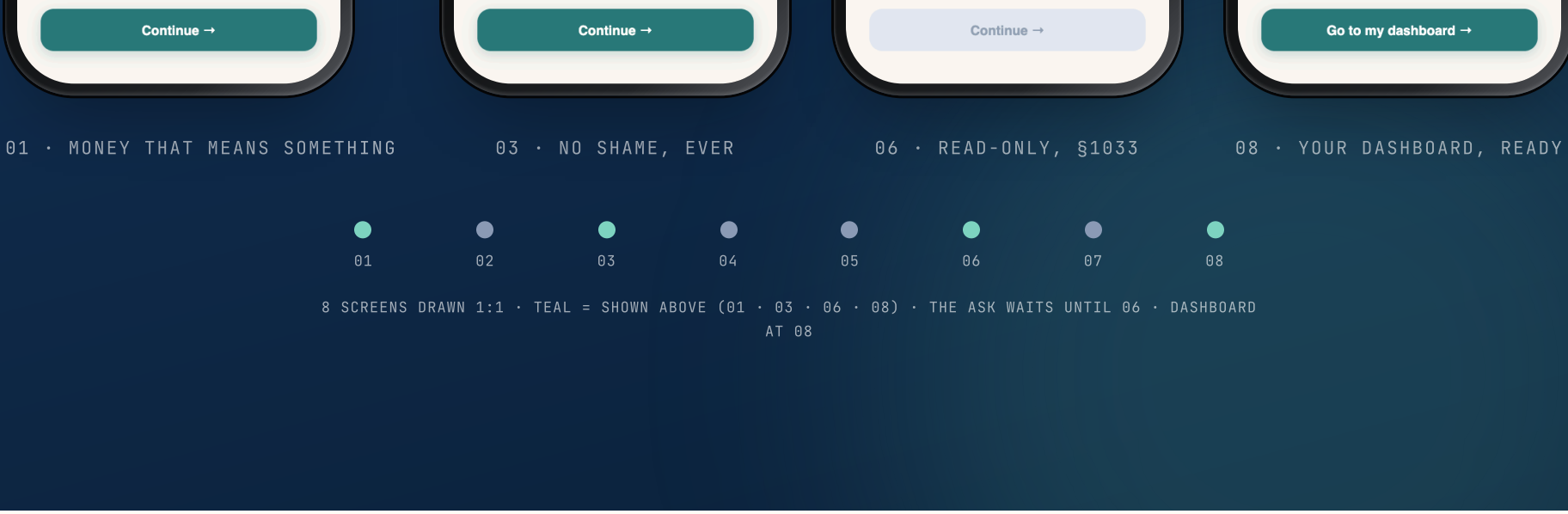
The conversational assistant is grounded in the user's own data and bounded by a strict information—not advice line, a trust moat, not a limitation.

THE "WHY?" PATTERN

Anywhere a number, projection, or nudge appears, a "Why?" reveals the plain-language arithmetic behind it. Trust as a repeating UI pattern.

ONBOARDING

Earning trust in *eight screens*



01 • MONEY THAT MEANS SOMETHING

03 • NO SHAME, EVER

06 • READ-ONLY, §1033

08 • YOUR DASHBOARD, READY

8 SCREENS DRAWN 1:1 • TEAL • SHOWN ABOVE (01 • 03 • 06 • 08) • THE ASK WAITS UNTIL 06 • DASHBOARD AT 08

THE OPPORTUNITY

Sizing the bet

165M

U.S. adults in the addressable market (TAM)

90M

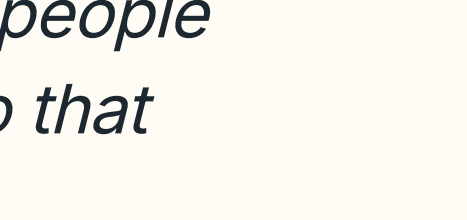
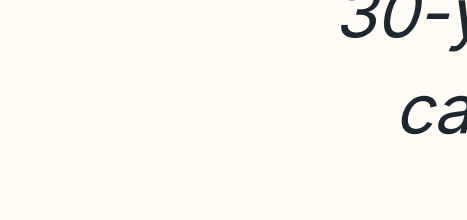
Serviceable market earning \$40K–\$250K

5

Incumbent PFM archetypes benchmarked

3–7

Financial accounts the average person juggles



FIGURES ARE DESK-RESEARCH ESTIMATES FRAMING A CONCEPT, NOT VALIDATED MARKET METRICS.

“

Translating a \$145 grocery bill into a position on a 30-year retirement trajectory is work most people can't do. The product's whole job is to do that translation, in public, every day.

LIVE • INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE

Try the *working build*

A fully interactive prototype, tap through goals, spending intelligence, the AI assistant, and onboarding. It runs live, right here.



OPEN PROTOTYPE IN A NEW TAB